

NOMIDDLENAME303



HOMEBREW

WEAPON MODIFICATIONS & EXPANSION

WEAPON MODIFICATIONS

The 2024 revision of 5e does a lot to make weapons and martial combat more interesting, but in my opinion there are still some improvements to be made. Namely:

Some Weapons Are The Same. Flails and Morningstars, for example, are practically identical weapons outside of damage type (which rarely makes a difference).

Some Weapons Are Redundant. In the same vein, both Flails and Morningstars are outclassed by the Longsword; all three weapons have a 1d8 damage die and the Sap mastery, but the Longsword has the Versatile (1d10) property on top.

Weapon Switching Is Optimal. In my opinion, the system should not punish martials that want to stick with one 'signature' weapon by denying them the versatility of multiple weapon masteries.

This document aims to address some of these issues, as well as being simple to use and drop into a running game.

NEW WEAPON MASTERIES

New weapon masteries are listed below.

AGILE

Before or after making an attack with this weapon, you can move up to 5 feet without provoking Opportunity Attacks. You can't move in this way if your Speed is 0.

DAZE

If you hit a creature with this weapon and deal damage to it, it can't make Opportunity Attacks until the start of your next turn.

EXPOSE

If you hit a creature with this weapon and deal damage to it, the next attack roll made by a creature other than you against that creature has Advantage if it's made before the start of your next turn.

FLURRY

If your attack roll with this weapon misses a creature, you can immediately make another attack against that creature with the weapon. You don't add your ability modifier to this attack's damage unless it's negative, and you can make this extra attack only once per turn.

CHANGED WEAPONS

The following weapons have received changes.

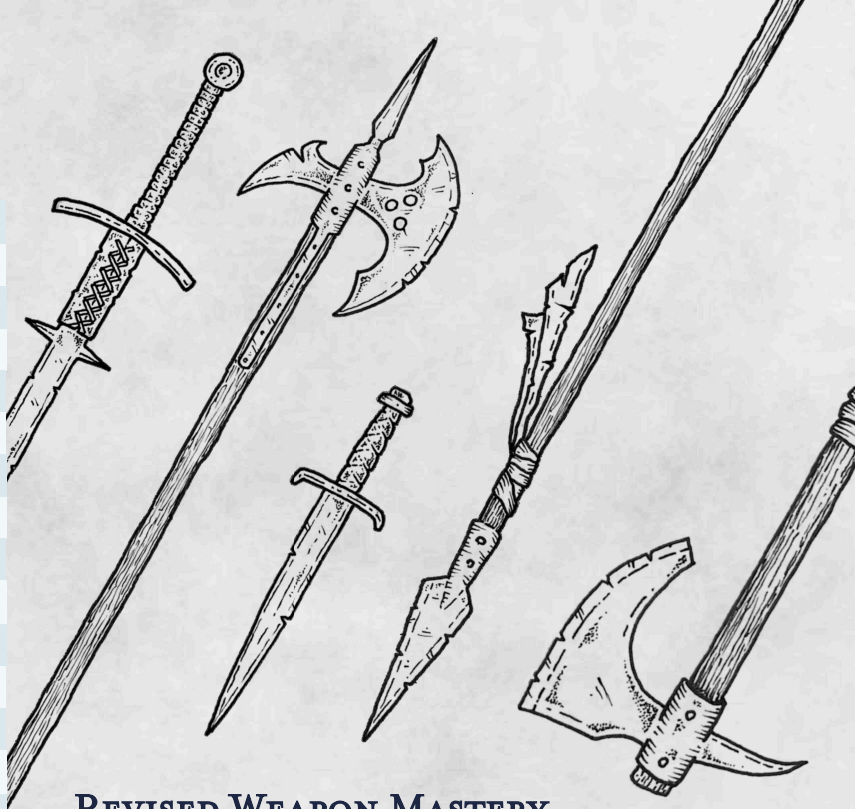
CHANGED WEAPONS

Weapon	Change
Battleaxe, Longsword, Warhammer, War Pick	When you make an attack using two hands with this weapon, you can apply an additional Mastery property you know for the weapon to the attack.
Light Hammer, Sickle	The weapon's damage die increases from 1d4 to 1d6.



WEAPON MASTERIES

Weapon	Masteries
<i>Simple Melee Weapons</i>	
Club	Daze , Slow
Dagger	Agile , Nick
Greatclub	Daze , Push
Handaxe	Nick , Vex
Javelin	Expose , Slow
Light Hammer	Expose , Nick
Mace	Daze , Sap
Quarterstaff	Flurry , Topple
Sickle	Flurry , Nick
Spear	Sap, Slow
<i>Simple Ranged Weapons</i>	
Dart	Agile , Vex
Light Crossbow	Sap , Slow
Shortbow	Agile , Vex
Sling	Expose , Slow
<i>Martial Melee Weapons</i>	
Battleaxe	Cleave , Slow , Topple
Flail	Daze , Expose , Flurry , Sap
Glaive	Cleave , Graze, Slow
Greataxe	Cleave, Flurry , Topple
Greatsword	Graze, Push , Sap
Halberd	Cleave, Push , Topple
Lance	Expose , Sap , Topple
Longsword	Agile , Graze , Sap
Maul	Daze , Expose , Topple
Morningstar	Graze , Sap, Slow , Vex
Pike	Expose , Push, Slow
Rapier	Expose , Flurry , Vex
Scimitar	Flurry , Nick, Sap
Shortsword	Agile , Nick , Vex
Trident	Expose , Slow , Topple
Warhammer	Daze , Expose , Push
War Pick	Expose , Sap, Vex
Whip	Flurry , Sap , Slow
<i>Martial Ranged Weapons</i>	
Blowgun	Agile , Daze , Graze , Sap , Slow , Vex
Hand Crossbow	Agile , Sap , Vex
Heavy Crossbow	Expose , Sap , Push
Longbow	Sap , Slow, Vex
Musket	Expose , Graze , Slow
Pistol	Agile , Graze , Vex



REVISED WEAPON MASTERY

The Weapon Mastery class feature now reads the following.

WEAPON MASTERY

You learn a number of Weapon Masteries equal to the number of weapons you would normally have mastery in with the old Weapon Mastery feature. For each Weapon Mastery you learn, you choose one weapon you're proficient in and learn one of its Mastery properties. You can change any number of your Weapon Masteries when you finish a Long Rest.

If you know multiple Mastery properties for a weapon, you can only use one of them per attack. You must choose which Mastery property you're using before making the attack.

If a Mastery allows you to make an additional attack with the same weapon, that attack can't benefit from Mastery properties.

REVISED GREAT WEAPON FIGHTING

The Great Weapon Fighting feat now reads the following.

GREAT WEAPON FIGHTING

When you roll damage for an attack you make with a Melee weapon you're holding with two hands, you can roll one additional damage die and ignore the lowest result. For example, if the weapon deals 2d6 damage, you instead roll 3d6 and ignore the lowest d6.

WEAPON EXPANSION

Below is a suite of rules for those who want a more comprehensive overhaul and expansion to weapons and martial combat. Each of these changes is piecemeal, and can be used individually as the DM sees fit.

NEW WEAPONS

New weapons are detailed in the table below.

VERSATILE WEAPONS

The Katana and War Spear both have additional benefits when you attack with them using two hands.

- The Katana can have two of its mastery properties apply to the attack, similar to the Battleaxe, Longsword, Warhammer and War Pick.
- The War Spear gains the Reach property for the attack.

NEW FIGHTING STYLES

New Fighting Style feats are listed below.

POLEARM FIGHTING

You gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls made with Reach weapons against targets not within 5 feet of you. Additionally, your attacks with Reach weapons ignore Half Cover granted by creatures.

VERSATILE WEAPON FIGHTING

You gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls made with a Versatile weapon while holding it in one hand, and a +2 bonus to damage rolls while holding it in two hands.

NEW WEAPONS

Name	Damage	Properties	Masteries	Weight	Cost
<i>Martial Melee Weapons</i>					
Bladed Chain	1d6 S	Reach	Push, Slow, Topple	5 lb.	5 GP
Heavy Javelin	1d8 P	Heavy, Thrown (Range 40/160)	Expose, Push, Slow	4 lb.	5 GP
Katana	1d6 S	Finesse, Versatile (1d8, Extra Mastery)	Flurry, Graze, Vex	3 lb.	30 GP
Polehammer	1d10 B	Heavy, Reach, Two-Handed	Daze, Expose, Topple	10 lb.	20 GP
Saber	1d8 S	Finesse	Agile, Sap, Slow	2 lb.	25 GP
War Spear	1d8 P	Versatile (1d10, Reach)	Sap, Slow, Vex	3 lb.	5 GP
<i>Martial Ranged Weapons</i>					
Blunderbuss	2d6 P	Ammunition (Range 20/60, Buckshot*), Loading, Two-Handed	Daze, Graze, Push	8 lb.	300 GP
Repeating Crossbow	2d4 P	Ammunition (Range 80/320, Bolt), Two-Handed	Flurry, Sap, Slow	6 lb.	100 GP
Throwing Dagger	1d6 P	Finesse, Light, Thrown (Range 30/90)	Agile, Flurry, Nick	1/4 lb.	2 GP

* Buckshot costs the same as a Firearm Bullet, and is also destroyed on use.

NEW FEATS

New General feats are listed below.

BOW MASTER

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Dexterity 13+

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Dexterity by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Overwatch. As a Bonus Action, you can nock an arrow in a Shortbow or Longbow (henceforth called bows in this feat) and designate a 20-foot Cube that fits entirely within the bow's normal range. Creatures that can see you know which area you designated.

Until the start of your next turn, when a creature enters the Cube, you can take a Reaction to make a ranged attack against that creature with the bow. You can't make this attack if the creature's movement into the Cube wouldn't provoke Opportunity Attacks.

LIGHT ARMOR MASTER

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Dexterity 13+

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Dexterity by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Mobile Defense. When you take an action to Dash, Disengage or Dodge while wearing Light armor, you gain a +2 bonus to your AC until the start of your next turn.

Slippery. While wearing Light armor, any attack roll made against you with Disadvantage rolls three d20s instead of two and takes the lowest result.



MARKSMAN

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Dexterity 13+

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Dexterity by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Singular Focus. When you make your first attack roll on your turn and it's made with a Blunderbuss, Musket or Pistol (henceforth called firearms in this feat), you can choose to gain Advantage on the attack roll. If you do, you make all other attack rolls with Disadvantage until the start of your next turn.

Zero In. When you take the Attack action on your turn, you can forgo any number of attacks to carefully aim with a firearm you're holding. For each attack you forgo, your next attack with the firearm before the end of your next turn deals an extra 2d8 damage on a hit, has its normal and long ranges increased by 30 feet, and has its Critical Hit Range increased by 1.

THROWN WEAPON MASTER

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Strength or Dexterity 13+

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength or Dexterity by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Ricocheting Return. When you miss on a ranged attack with a Light Thrown weapon, you can have it

return to your hand, as the weapon ricochets off walls and obstacles to return to you.

Fan of Knives. When you take the Attack action on your turn and make only ranged attacks with Light Thrown weapons, with each attack targeting a different creature or object, you can make an additional ranged attack with a Thrown weapon as part of that action. This extra attack must have a different target from the other attacks you made for your Attack action.

TITAN SLAYER

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Strength or Constitution 13+

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength or Constitution by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Escape Artist. You can take the Escape as a Grapple action as a Bonus Action.

Scale Foe. You can Grapple creatures that are two or more sizes larger than you. If you successfully do so, the creature's Speed isn't reduced to 0 feet while Grappled in this way; instead, you climb onto the creature and move with it until the Grapple ends.

Iron Body. When you fail a Strength, Dexterity, or Constitution saving throw, you can choose to succeed instead. Once you use this benefit, you can't use it again until you finish a Short or Long Rest.

TUSSLER

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Strength or Dexterity 13+

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength or Dexterity by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Punch and Shove. When you hit a creature with an Unarmed Strike as part of the Attack action on your turn, you can use both the Damage and the Shove option. You can use this benefit only once per turn.

Knockback. When you Shove a creature and push it, you can push it up to 15 feet back rather than 5 feet.

Knockdown. When you Shove a creature and give it the Prone condition, you can deal 1d6 Bludgeoning damage to the creature.

VERSATILE COMBATANT

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Strength or Dexterity 13+

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength or Dexterity by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Off-Hand Strike. Once per turn, when you hit a creature with a Versatile weapon you're wielding with one hand, you can immediately make an Unarmed Strike against the target, provided you have a free hand.

Two-Handed Flurry. Once per turn, when you miss a creature with a Versatile weapon you're wielding with two hands, you can reroll the attack roll against the same creature.

CHANGED FEATS

Feats that are changed from their PHB counterparts are listed below, and completely replace their PHB counterparts.

HEAVY ARMOR MASTER

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Heavy Armor Training

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength or Constitution by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Damage Reduction. When you're hit by an attack while you're wearing Heavy armor, any Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing damage dealt to you by that attack is reduced by an amount equal to your Proficiency Bonus.

If the Heavy armor you're wearing is Magical, you can also apply this damage reduction against attacks that deal any damage type, not just Bludgeoning, Piercing, or Slashing.

MEDIUM ARMOR MASTER

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Medium Armor Training

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength or Dexterity by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Dexterous Wearer. While you're wearing Medium armor, you can add 3, rather than 2 to your AC if you have a Dexterity score of 16 or higher.

Armored Reflexes. While you're wearing Medium armor, you have Advantage on Dexterity saving throws you make to take only half damage from an effect.

RESILIENT

Prerequisites: Level 4+

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Choose one ability in which you lack saving throw proficiency. Increase the chosen ability score by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Saving Throw Proficiency. You gain saving throw proficiency with the chosen ability.

Uncommon Save Proficiency. If your chosen ability is Strength, Intelligence or Charisma, you also gain saving throw proficiency with a different one of those abilities.

SHARPSHOOTER

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Dexterity 13+

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Dexterity by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Lessen Cover. Your ranged attacks with weapons ignore Half Cover and treat Three-Quarters Cover as Half Cover.

Increased Normal Range. The normal range of your ranged attacks with weapons is doubled, to a maximum of the weapon's long range.

Precise Shots. When you make a ranged attack with a Ranged weapon against a creature, you can add a d6 to the attack roll if you have Advantage on the attack roll or if the target is suffering from a reduction to its Speed.

SPELL SNIPER

Prerequisites: Level 4+, Spellcasting or Pact Magic feature

You gain the following benefits.

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Intelligence, Wisdom, or Charisma by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Lessen Cover. Your attack rolls for spells ignore Half Cover and treat Three-Quarters Cover as Half Cover.

Increased Spell Range. When you cast a spell that requires a spell attack roll, you can increase the spell's range by 60 feet if it has a range of 10 feet or higher, or make the spell's range 60 feet if its range is Touch.

Critical Spells. Your Critical Hit Range for spell attack rolls increases by 1.

CRITICAL HIT RANGE

When a feature increases your Critical Hit Range by a number, the minimum number you have to roll on the d20 of an attack roll to score a Critical Hit (20 by default) decreases by that number. If you have multiple features that increase your Critical Hit Range, the increases stack.

For example, if you have a feature that increases your Critical Hit Range by 1, you now score Critical Hits on a roll of 19 or above on the d20. If you later gain a feature that increases your Critical Hit Range by 2, you score Critical Hits on a roll of 17 or above.

It is recommended to amend any features that explicitly define an expanded critical range (such as the Champion fighter's Improved Critical and Superior Critical) to increase Critical Hit Range instead.

ART CREDITS

- Medieval Armory Relight (UE4) by Dmitry Masaltsev
- Bolton Flayed Men by Stefan Kopinski
- The Old-School Armory – weapon illustrations by Paths Peculiar
- Duelist by Laura Hantschel